

1 — Problem Definition

- **What:** Single-use plastic pollution—specifically everyday items like plastic bags, straws, and single-use water bottles—entering marine environments, breaking into microplastics, and choking or entangling marine life.
- **For Whom:** Primary school students (ages 6–10)
- **Where:** Global ocean ecosystems—from coastal shorelines to the open ocean—fed by rivers and storm drains worldwide.
- **When:** Present day, escalating daily with current global plastic production and disposal habits.
- **How Big:** Approximately 11 million metric tons of plastic flow into the ocean every year. Plastics make up 85% of total marine litter, threatening over 700 marine species. Without intervention, plastic waste in the ocean is projected to triple by 2040.
 - According to the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) and UNESCO, 80% of ocean plastic enters from land via rivers and stormwater, and over 100,000 marine mammals and 1 million seabirds die each year from plastic ingestion or entanglement.

2 — User Group

- **Primary Audience:** Primary school children (ages 6–10). They are highly empathetic, visually driven, and respond best to relatable character-driven stories with clear, simple moral choices.
- **What They Already Believe:**
 - "When I drop a plastic wrapper or bottle in the bin, it disappears forever."
 - "The ocean is huge, so one small piece of plastic won't hurt anything."
 - "Only adults can do big things to fix the planet."
- **Who the Film is NOT For:** High school or university environmental science students, policymakers, or corporate executives. It avoids complex chemical breakdowns, technical policy jargon, or disturbing graphic footage.

3 — SDG

Which one? SDG 13 Climate action - Target 13.3 Build knowledge and capacity to meet climate change.

How it addresses this SDG

- Connecting Land Waste to Ocean Climate Resilience
 - The film demonstrates how human consumption on land (single-use trash, abandoned fishing gear) directly destroys marine ecosystems.
 - By showing that marine waste kills fish and degrades reefs, the film teaches children that healthy ocean life is essential for maintaining a stable climate.
- Translating Complex Ecological Harm into Concrete Narrative
 - Showing a tragic family loss gives kids a clear cause-and-effect relationship ("*Our waste destroys ocean families*"), fulfilling Target 13.3's goal of building early awareness.

4 – Solution description

N°	Duration	Description of the shot	Image Prompt	Motion prompt
1.	3 seconds	Opening shot of beneath the sea. Very colourful, full of life	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, wide shot of a healthy coral reef, pink, orange and purple corals, turquoise water, light rays from above	Light rays shimmer and move slowly over a colorful coral reef. Tiny bubbles rise. The corals sway gently in the current. The camera glides slowly forward. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors
2.	3 seconds	Dad pufferfish playing with the child pufferfish	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, two small cute cartoon (pufferfish:1.3) character, round body, yellow with brown spots, big round eyes, small fins, one bigger and one smaller, chasing each other between corals, turquoise water	Two small cartoon pufferfish chase each other from left to right, looping around one another playfully. Their small fins flap fast. The camera pans to follow them. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors
3.	3 seconds	Mom pufferfish warmly watching them	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, two big cute cartoon (pufferfish:1.3) character, round body, yellow with brown spots, big round eyes, small fins, side by side, smiling warmly, looking to the right, colorful corals behind	Two cartoon pufferfish float side by side and smile. They blink and their small fins flap gently. Small bubbles rise. The camera slowly pushes in. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors
4.	3 seconds	Human waste is thrown into the ocean	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, (crushed plastic bottles:1.3) and (torn plastic bags:1.2) scattered and floating at different heights, messy, tilted, bottle caps and crumpled wrappers, murky green water, no fish	Crushed plastic bottles, torn bags and wrappers slowly drift down into the murky water and spread out. The camera stays still. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors

N°	Duration	Description of the shot	Image Prompt	Motion prompt
5.	4 seconds	<i>Dad tries to find food but eats trash instead</i>	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, one small cute cartoon (pufferfish:1.3) character, round body, yellow with brown spots, big round eyes, small fins trapped and tangled in (plastic six-pack rings:1.3) and a (torn plastic bag:1.2) wrapped around its body, sad worried face, surrounded by floating plastic trash, murky green water	A small cartoon pufferfish stares at the floating plastic trash in shock, its eyes wide and its mouth open. It slowly backs away. Plastic trash drifts slowly around it. The camera slowly pushes in. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors
6.	3 seconds	<i>Mom gets caught by fishing net</i>	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, a large dark (fishing net:1.4) with a (square mesh grid pattern:1.3) of knotted ropes, hanging down from above, round floats along the top edge of the net, grey-green water	A dark fishing net with a square rope mesh slowly sinks down from the top left toward the pufferfish, the net stays clearly visible the whole time. The pufferfish puff up in fear and swim away to the right. The camera stays completely still. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors
7.	4 seconds	<i>Child is left alone in a dark and polluted sea</i>	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, one tiny cute cartoon (pufferfish:1.3) character, round body, yellow with brown spots, big round eyes, small fins alone, sad face, (deep underwater:1.4), everything is under water, murky seabed covered in (piles of plastic trash:1.3), grey rocks, (floating plastic bottles and plastic bags:1.3), (dark murky blue-grey polluted water:1.4), dim gloomy light, lifeless and empty shapes, no texture, underwater scene, (deep underwater:1.4), everything is under water, murky seabed covered in (piles of plastic trash:1.3), grey rocks, (floating plastic bottles and plastic bags:1.3), (dark murky blue-grey polluted water:1.4), dim gloomy light, lifeless and empty	A tiny cartoon pufferfish floats almost in place in dark blue water, bobbing slowly up and down, looking down sadly, its fins drooping. Empty plastic bottles drift slowly past. Grey rocks and plastic trash lie still on the dark seabed. The camera stays completely still. The colors and lighting stay the same: dark blue water, dim light. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors

N°	Duration	Description of the shot	Image Prompt	Motion prompt
8.	3 seconds	<i>A single green coral sprout to show that if we take action there is still hope.</i>	(flat 2D cartoon:1.4), thick black outlines, solid color fills, simple cel shading, (kids TV cartoon style:1.2), clean simple shapes, no texture, underwater scene, close-up of a single small bright green coral sprout on a grey seabed, a soft ray of light from above	A soft ray of light falls on a small green coral sprout. The sprout sways gently and glows brighter. Tiny bubbles rise. The camera slowly pushes in. Flat 2D cartoon animation with thick black outlines and solid colors

* We made some minor adjustments to the story afterwards so that it better matches the visuals and ensures that the explanations align with what actually happens in the video.

5 — Problem-Solution Fit

Why our 30-second film reaches, inspires, and convinces our audience

1. Leveraging high baseline animal empathy

- Children aged 6–10 possess a high level of affective empathy toward animals, often viewing them as moral equals with feelings and family structures similar to human ones.
- Why the Story Works: Framing marine animals as a relatable "family unit" (father, mother, child) gives young viewers an immediate emotional anchor. When the father dies from ingesting plastic trash and the mother is trapped in a ghost fishing net, the film transforms an abstract ecological issue into a personal, emotional loss that children care about.
- Academic Basis: Research in the *Journal of Environmental Psychology* demonstrates that narrative visuals depicting direct harm to animal characters generate significantly higher pro-environmental commitment in primary school children than statistical warnings or generic environmental landscapes.

2. Cognitive fit: concrete cause-and-effect in 30 seconds

- Children aged 6–10 process information best through concrete operational logic—simple, direct cause-and-effect relationships rather than complex policy or biochemical explanations.
- Why the Story Works: A 30-second arc provides the exact right timeframe to deliver a clear 3-act emotional punch without losing focus:
 - Connection: Introduce the happy fish family in a vibrant ocean reef.
 - The Tragedy: Human litter enters the water—the father fish eats plastic debris thinking it is food; the mother is ensnared by a discarded fishing net.
 - The Realization & Call to Action: The surviving young fish is left alone, directly connecting land-based human litter to tragic marine consequences, driving home the personal habit message ("*Our single-use choices destroy underwater families*").

Why our specific audience (Primary School Kids) should be reached

1. Habit formation

- The Research: A landmark study from Brown University (*The Learning Habit Study*, Pressman et al.) established that core household routines, consumption habits, and waste behaviors are largely fixed by age 9.
- Which is why... Intervening in primary school forms eco-friendly baseline habits (such as using reusable water bottles and properly disposing of trash) before bad habits become ingrained. It is significantly easier to build positive habits early than to unlearn wasteful habits in adulthood.

2. Peak environmental receptivity

- The Research: Environmental psychology studies indicate that natural affinity for animals reaches its peak between ages 6 and 10, before experiencing a documented dip during early adolescence (ages 11–14) due to shifting social priorities.
- Which is why... Primary school children are at their most emotionally open stage to care deeply about marine welfare, making them the most responsive audience for an emotionally driven story about a suffering fish family.

3. Child-to-Parent influence

- The Research: Empirical research published in *Nature Climate Change* (Lawson et al., 2019) proved that educating children about environmental issues directly transfers to their parents—a process known as *intergenerational learning*. Furthermore, consumer research (*NielsenIQ*, *Harvard Business Review*) shows that 80% to 85% of parents report that their primary-school-aged children directly influence household purchasing decisions, especially regarding single-use items, lunchbox packaging, and reusables.
- Which is why... Children can act as "eco-ambassadors" in the home. When a child is moved by the tragedy of the fish family, they talk to their parents, prompting shifts in household waste habits that bypass the political or ideological resistance often held by adults.

6 — Ethical Reasoning

- **Informing vs. Misleading:** The film informs by accurately demonstrating how human litter reaches global oceans and affects marine species. It avoids misleading by keeping creature behaviors realistic rather than creating sensationalized, fictional sea monsters.
- **Real Places & Events:** The setting represents a generalized, global coral reef and open ocean rather than pretending to document a specific, real-world historical event or precise coordinate.

* Background music

* Youtube link